LESSON PACK · WEEK 2 · LESSON 2 · ACCIDENTS AND EMERGENCIES

When it happened

Grammar · Past Continuous: negatives and questions

Words · Emergencies and rescue





BY THE END YOU CAN SAY

Were you sleeping when the alarm rang? No, I wasn't.

What were you doing when the lights went out?

WARM-UP · ELEMENTARY IS STILL ALIVE

Let's talk first

1. Elementary: What are you going to do after class? Do you think it will be a nice day tomorrow?

   Elementary: Что ты собираешься делать после урока? Как думаешь, завтра будет хорошая погода?

2. What were you doing at nine o'clock last night? Say one sentence.

   Что ты делал вчера в девять часов вечера? Скажи одно предложение.

DID YOU KNOW?

In a fire, smoke is more dangerous than flames: stay low and get out.

При пожаре дым опаснее огня: пригнитесь и выходите на улицу.

CORE WORDS 1 / 2

Today's 20 words



fire
пожар

T

trapped
в ловушке

S

smoke
дым

C

collapse
обрушиться



firefighter
пожарный

E

earthquake
землетрясение

R

rescue
спасать

L

landslide
оползень

S

save
спасти

P

power outage
отключение электричества

CORE WORDS 2 / 2

Today's 20 words

E **elevator**
лифт

S **siren**
сирена

S **stuck**
застрявший

V **victim**
пострадавший

P **panic**
паника

S **survivor**
выживший

S **shout**
кричать

B **bystander**
свидетель, прохожий

E **emergency exit**
аварийный выход

S **shelter**
укрытие

EXTRA WORDS 1 / 2 · ONLY IF YOU WANT MORE

20 extra words, easy to use

F
flood
наводнение

E
evacuate
эвакуировать

H
hurricane
ураган

A
alarm
сигнализация, тревога


tornado
торнадо

H
hazard
опасность

B
blizzard
метель

R
rescuer
спасатель

E
explosion
взрыв

F
flame
пламя

EXTRA WORDS 2 / 2 · ONLY IF YOU WANT MORE

20 extra words, easy to use

F
fire extinguisher
огнетушитель

H
helmet
шлем, каска

L
life jacket
спасательный жилет

F
flashlight
фонарик

S
supplies
припасы

R
rubble
обломки

M
missing
пропавший

S
search party
поисковая группа

D
debris
обломки, мусор

W
wreck
крушение, обломки

HOW IT WORKS · 1

Negatives: wasn't / weren't + -ing

I wasn't sleeping. ✓
Я не спал.

They weren't watching TV. ✓
Они не смотрели телевизор.

She wasn't driving fast. ✓
Она ехала не быстро.

wasn't / weren't + verb-ing
wasn't / weren't + глагол с -ing

wasn't = was not · weren't = were not
Краткие формы

Use it to say what was NOT in progress: nobody was running
Что НЕ происходило

HOW IT WORKS · 2

Questions: Was / Were + subject + -ing

Were you wearing a seat belt? ✓
На тебе был ремень безопасности?

Was he driving fast? ✓
Он ехал быстро?

Were they sleeping? ✓
Они спали?

Was / Were + subject + verb-ing?
Was / Were + подлежащее + -ing

Short answers: Yes, I was. / No, I wasn't. Yes, they were. / No, they weren't.
Краткие ответы

No did: Were you sleeping? ✓ · Did you were sleeping? ✗
did здесь не нужен

HOW IT WORKS · 3

What were you doing when the fire started?

I was cooking dinner.

Что ты делал, когда начался пожар? Я готовил ужин.

Where was she standing?

She was standing near the exit.

Где она стояла? Она стояла возле выхода.

Who was driving?

My uncle was driving.

Кто был за рулём? Мой дядя.

Why were they running?

They were running because of the smoke.

Почему они бежали? Из-за дыма.

Wh- word + was / were + subject + -ing

Вопросительное слово + was / were + подлежащее + -ing

With Who there is no subject:
Who was driving?

С Who подлежащего нет

Answer with the past continuous

Отвечайте в past continuous

HOW IT WORKS · 4

Emergency interview

What were you doing	when the fire started?
Where were you standing	when the lights went out?
Were you wearing	a seat belt?
Was anybody running	to the exit?

The reporter asks, the witness answers in the past continuous

Репортёр спрашивает, свидетель отвечает

Use today's words: fire, smoke, rescue, trapped, shelter

Используйте слова урока

WATCH OUT

Four mistakes to avoid

Did you sleeping at ten? ✗
→ **Were you sleeping at ten?** ✓
Were + -ing

Was they running? ✗
→ **Were they running?** ✓
they → were

I wasn't sleep. ✗
→ **I wasn't sleeping.** ✓
wasn't + -ing

What you were doing? ✗
→ **What were you doing?** ✓
were стоит перед you

EXAMPLE SENTENCES

Look and say

Were you sleeping when the alarm rang?
Ты спал, когда прозвенел будильник?

No, I wasn't. I was reading.
Нет. Я читал.

What were you doing when the lights went out?
Что ты делал, когда погас свет?

Where was he standing?
Где он стоял?

They weren't wearing helmets.
На них не было шлемов.

The firefighters were working all night.
Пожарные работали всю ночь.

Was anybody standing near the exit?
Кто-нибудь стоял возле выхода?

Nobody was panicking.
Никто не паниковал.

WORDS THAT GO TOGETHER

Collocations and phrasal verbs

5 COLLOCATIONS

catch fire
загореться

raise the alarm
поднять тревогу

run for your life
бежать, спасая жизнь

come to the rescue
прийти на помощь

be in danger
быть в опасности

2 PHRASAL VERBS

put out
потушить

break down
сломаться

Make one sentence with each of them. They are part of today's homework.

SPEAKING

Emergency interview

1. Work in pairs: a reporter and a witness. Choose an emergency: a fire, an earthquake or a power outage.
2. The reporter asks 5 questions: What were you doing? Where were you standing? Were you…?
3. The witness answers with the past continuous and invents the details.
4. Change roles. Then tell the class one story.

EXAMPLE

A What were you doing when the earthquake started?

B I was sitting in the kitchen.

A Were you alone?

B No, I wasn't. My sister was studying in the next room.

Reporter: use Was / Were first in yes-no questions. Witness: short answer + one more sentence.

PLAY TO PRACTICE

Games with a working link

Baamboozle: Past Simple and past continuous when/while

https://www.baamboozle.com/game/3683335

Put both verbs in the right form (What were you doing when I called?) and read the whole sentence aloud. Game code 3683335.

On the laptop: click the link, press **Play**, choose 2 to 4 teams. All pages were opened and checked on 31 Oct 2026.

LISTENING

Watch and listen

VOA Let's Learn English, Level 1, Lesson 38: She's My Best Friend!

https://learningenglish.voanews.com/a/lets-learn-english-lesson-38-shes-my-best-friend/3591967.html

Video lesson with text and exercises.

VOA Let's Learn English, Level 2, Lesson 29: Where There's Smoke...

https://learningenglish.voanews.com/a/lets-learn-english-level-2-lesson-29/4423736.html

Video lesson with text and exercises. Harder (Level 2): listen for the main idea.

Pick the one you like. First for the main idea, then again with the text.

LAST 5 MINUTES

Say it! Exit check

1. **Make it negative:** She was sleeping.
2. **Ask:** they / wear / helmets
3. **Answer:** Were you running? (No)
4. **Ask:** what / he / do
5. **Correct it:** Did you sleeping?

Ask aloud, one student at a time. The answers are on the last page.

LAST 10 MINUTES

Speak! Recap with questions

1. Were you sleeping at ten o'clock last night?
2. What were you doing at six o'clock this morning?
3. Where were you standing when the lesson started?
4. Was it raining when you left home?
5. Who were you talking to an hour ago?
6. What was your mother doing at noon?
7. Were your parents watching TV last night?
8. Why were you smiling a minute ago?

Ask in pairs, then ask the whole class. Perfect sentences, please: stop and repeat if there is a mistake.

TEACHER · ANSWERS

Answer key · exercises

1 · Make it negative

1. I wasn't sleeping. · 2. They weren't watching TV. ·
3. She wasn't driving fast. · 4. We weren't waiting outside. ·
5. He wasn't wearing a helmet.

2 · Make questions

1. Were you sleeping? · 2. Was he driving fast? ·
3. Were they wearing seat belts? · 4. Was she standing near the exit? ·
5. Was the bus moving? · 6. Were your friends running?

3 · Short answers

1. No, I wasn't. · 2. Yes, he was. · 3. No, they weren't. ·
4. Yes, she was. · 5. Yes, we were.

4 · Write the Wh- question

1. What were you doing? · 2. Where was he standing? ·
3. Who was driving? · 4. Why were they running? ·
5. What was she carrying?

5 · Read and write T (true) or F (false)

1. F · 2. F · 3. T · 4. T · 5. F

6 · About you

Personal answers. Check was / were / wasn't / weren't + verb-ing.

TEACHER · ANSWERS

Answer key · exit check and homework

EXIT CHECK

1. Make it negative: She was sleeping. → She wasn't sleeping.
2. Ask: they / wear / helmets → Were they wearing helmets?
3. Answer: Were you running? (No) → No, I wasn't.
4. Ask: what / he / do → What was he doing?
5. Correct it: Did you sleeping? → Were you sleeping?

RUSSIAN → ENGLISH

1. Ты спал, когда зазвонил телефон? → Were you sleeping when the phone rang?
2. Нет, я не спал. Я читал. → No, I wasn't. I was reading.
3. Что ты делал, когда погас свет? → What were you doing when the lights went out?
4. Где он стоял? → Where was he standing?
5. На них не было шлемов. → They weren't wearing helmets.
6. Пожарные работали всю ночь. → The firefighters were working all night.
7. Кто-нибудь стоял возле выхода? → Was anybody standing near the exit?
8. Никто не паниковал. → Nobody was panicking.
9. Почему они бежали? → Why were they running?
10. Она не водила машину быстро. → She wasn't driving fast.